

RESPIRATORY DISTRESS	IMMEDIATE ACTIONS
Presence of ANY ONE: • RR >60/min • Chest retractions • Nasal flaring • Grunting	• Assess and stabilize TABC (temperature, airway, breathing, circulation) • Admit to SNCU/NICU ◦ Provide thermal care ◦ Attach pulse oximeter ◦ Monitor HR, RR, SpO₂ and CRT; grade severity using Silverman-Andersen score (SAS) • Feed enterally if stable ◦ Direct breastfeed if mild distress; gastric-tube feeds if moderate distress, or on CPAP • IV fluids if severe distress, recurrent apnea, poor perfusion, or abdominal signs

